Census and Urbanisation Topic 5 — Migration and Population Distribution

Current Affairs

Year	Fact	Why it matters
Rolling	Refresh edition-bound figures from latest Census / Survey / State CA desks.	Do not invent interim totals.

UP district extremes also → UP Special Topic 6. This chapter owns the national Census / demography desk.

Teaching cards

2.1 Spatial Distribution & Migration Dynamics in India

A. Internal Migration Magnitude in India (Census 2011)

- As per Census 2011, **45.36 Crore Indians (37.5% of the total population)** were classified as internal migrants by place of last residence (up from 31.45 Crore in 2001).
- **Categorisation by Movement Scale**: 1. **Intra-District Migrants**: Movement within the same district (**62%** of all migrants — predominantly female marriage migration). 2. **Inter-District Migrants**: Movement across districts within the same State (**26%**). 3. **Inter-State Migrants**: Movement across State boundaries (**12%**, approx. 5.4 Crore migrants).

B. Reasons for Migration (Gender Asymmetry in Census 2011)

- **Female Migration Drivers**:
- **Marriage accounts for 66.7%** (two-thirds) of all female migration in India due to traditional patrilocal village exogamy.
- Movement with household / parents accounts for ~15%.
- Employment / work accounts for only ~3%.
- **Male Migration Drivers**:
- **Work / Employment / Business is the primary driver (approx. 38%–40%)** for male internal migration.
- Movement with household accounts for ~25%.
- Education accounts for ~6%.
- Marriage accounts for only ~2% to 4% of male migration.



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| Marriage:                ~66.7%  |          | Employment / Work:       ~38.0%  |
| Moved with Household:    ~15.2%  |          | Moved with Household:    ~25.1%  |
| Work / Business:          ~3.0%  |          | Education:                ~6.2%  |
| Education:                ~1.5%  |          | Marriage:                 ~3.2%  |
| Other Reasons:           ~13.6%  |          | Other Reasons:           ~27.5%  |
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2.2 Major Migration Corridors & Socio-Economic Impact

A. Inter-State Migration Corridors

1. **Out-Migration Origins (Net Source States)**: - **Uttar Pradesh** is the single largest source of out-migrants in India, followed closely by **Bihar**, Rajasthan, and Madhya Pradesh. - Characterized by high agrarian demographic pressure, small landholdings, low industrial base, and wage differentials.
2. **In-Migration Destinations (Net Inflow States)**: - **Maharashtra** is the top destination state in India (attracting ~20% of all inter-state migrants, primarily in the Mumbai Metropolitan Region and Pune). - **National Capital Territory of Delhi (NCT)** is the second largest destination. - Other major in-migration hubs: **Gujarat** (Surat diamond/textile hub, Ahmedabad), **Haryana** (Gurugram, Faridabad), **Karnataka** (Bengaluru tech hub), **Tamil Nadu**, and **Punjab** (seasonal farm labour).

B. Socio-Economic Consequences of Migration

- **Positive Impacts**:
- **Remittance Inflows (Money Order Economy)**: Substantial financial support for rural families in Eastern UP and Bihar, financing education, health, and debt redemption.
- Efficient spatial reallocation of labour from surplus agricultural regions to labour-deficit industrial and service corridors.
- **Negative Impacts**:
- **Brain Drain and Rural Depopulation**: Skewed rural demographic structure leaving behind aging elderly and women (feminization of agriculture).
- Emergence of **"Ghost Villages"** (*Bhootia Gaon*) in the middle-altitude hill districts of Uttarakhand (e.g., Almora, Pauri Garhwal).
- Severe civic and infrastructural strain on recipient urban metropolises: rapid expansion of unplanned **slums**, shortage of drinking water, sanitation deficits, and traffic congestion.

Bilingual Terminology -- Migration and Population Distribution

English Term	Hindi Term	Key Anchor
Migration (प्रवास)	प्रवास	Movement from place of origin to destination
In-Migration (आंतरिक अंतःप्रवास)	अंतःप्रवास	Moving INTO a place/region from elsewhere within country
Out-Migration (बाह्यप्रवास)	बाह्यप्रवास	Moving OUT OF a place/region to elsewhere within country
Immigration (आप्रवास)	अप्रवासन	Entering a country from another country

English Term	Hindi Term	Key Anchor
Emigration (उत्प्रवास)	उत्प्रवासन	Leaving one's country to settle in another
Refugee (शरणार्थी)	शरणार्थी	Person forced to flee due to persecution, conflict
Internally Displaced Person (IDP)	आंतरिक रूप से विस्थापित व्यक्ति	Displaced within national boundaries; not crossing borders
Brain Drain (प्रतिभा पलायन)	प्रतिभा पलायन	Migration of skilled/educated people from developing to developed countries
Remittances (प्रेषण)	प्रेषण/विप्रेषण	Money sent by migrants to home country/family
Push Factors (बाहर धकेलने वाले कारक)	प्रतिकर्षण कारक	Factors forcing people to leave origin (poverty, drought, unemployment)
Pull Factors (खींचने वाले कारक)	अपकर्षण कारक	Factors attracting migrants to destination (jobs, facilities, education)
Seasonal Migration (मौसमी प्रवास)	मौसमी प्रवास	Short-term movement driven by agricultural seasons
Circular Migration (चक्रीय प्रवास)	चक्रीय प्रवास	Regular to-and-fro migration between rural and urban areas
Net Migration	शुद्ध प्रवास	In-migration minus out-migration for a given area
Ravenstein's Laws of Migration	रेवेन्स्टीन के प्रवास नियम	Foundational rules: most migrants move short distances; migration proceeds step-by-step

Extended Theory -- Migration: Types, Causes, and India's Patterns



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BY DURATION:
Permanent | Semi-permanent | Seasonal | Circular

BY CAUSE:
Voluntary (economic, educational, marriage)
vs. Forced (conflict, disaster, persecution)
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India's Migration Patterns (Census 2011)

Migration Category	Key Facts (Census 2011)
Total Migrants (lifetime)	~45.36 crore (~37% of total population)
Dominant stream	Rural to Rural (most common -- marriage-driven, esp. women)
Fastest growing stream	Rural to Urban (economic migration for employment)
Maharashtra	Largest in-migration State -- Mumbai's pull
Delhi (NCT)	Highest inter-state in-migration (relative density)
Uttar Pradesh	Largest source State of out-migrants
Bihar	2nd largest source State of out-migrants
Rajasthan	Major labour out-migration to Gujarat, Maharashtra
Kerala	Highest remittance-receiving State from Gulf countries
Major causes in UP	Lack of employment in eastern UP; agrarian distress; seasonal farm labour
Reverse migration	During COVID-19 (2020): ~1 crore migrants returned to UP and Bihar

Ravenstein's Laws of Migration (1885)

1. Most migrants move **short distances**
2. Migration proceeds **step-by-step** (small town → larger town → metropolis)
3. Migrants moving long distances prefer **large urban centres**
4. **Urban dwellers migrate less** than rural dwellers
5. **Women migrate more** than men for marriage (over short distances)
6. **Economic motives** dominate voluntary migration
7. Migration increases with **development of transport**

One-Liner Revision -- Migration

#	Fast Fact
1	Total lifetime migrants in India (Census 2011) = ~45.36 crore (~37%)
2	Most dominant internal stream = **Rural to Rural** (marriage-driven)

#	Fast Fact
3	Fastest growing internal stream = **Rural to Urban** (economic)
4	Largest out-migration source State = **Uttar Pradesh**
5	Largest in-migration destination State = **Maharashtra**
6	Highest remittance State = **Kerala** (Gulf migration)
7	Ravenstein's Laws (1885) -- first scientific theory of migration
8	Push factors = poverty, unemployment, drought, conflict
9	Pull factors = jobs, education, healthcare, infrastructure
10	Brain Drain = skilled emigration to developed countries
11	COVID-19 reverse migration (2020) = ~1 crore returned to UP/Bihar
12	International migration = immigration (into) + emigration (out)
13	Refugee = forced migrant crossing international border
14	IDP = internally displaced person (stays within country)
15	Circular migration = regular to-and-fro between rural and urban areas
16	Delhi = highest inter-state in-migration density
17	Women migrate more than men over SHORT distances (marriage)
18	Men migrate more than women over LONG distances (employment)
19	Everett Lee (1966) -- Push-Pull Theory of Migration
20	Net migration = In-migration MINUS Out-migration